Spot It, Stop It

Scam awareness training for teams · 45 minutes

WHY THIS MATTERS

Scams aimed at businesses are a people problem, not a tech problem

- Business email compromise costs US businesses billions of dollars a year (FBI IC3)
- Most attacks start with a message to a person, not a hack of a computer
- Small businesses are targeted because they have fewer checks
- One rushed payment or one shared code can be enough

TODAY

What we'll cover

- The 3 tells every scam shares
- Email: phishing, fake bosses, fake invoices, payroll changes
- Phone, voice and video: fake IT, codes, voice clones
- The verify rule and how to report here
- 3 practice scenarios, a short quiz, and your certificate

REMEMBER THIS IF NOTHING ELSE

Every scam has the same 3 tells

1 Rush: “I need this in the next hour.”

2 Secrecy or a broken process: “Keep this between us,” “skip the usual approval.”

3 An unusual payment or request: gift cards, new bank details, crypto, a code, remote access.

Email and messages

Phishing · fake bosses · fake invoices · payroll

5 red flags in one email

From: IT Service Desk <it-support@brightline-helpdesk.example>

ACTION REQUIRED: Your mailbox will be disabled today

Your email password expires in 2 hours. To avoid losing access to your mailbox and files, re-confirm your account now.

[Keep my mailbox active]

IT Service Desk

RED FLAGS

- Sender domain isn't ours (brightline-helpdesk.example)
- Urgent deadline: “2 hours”
- Threat: losing access
- A login button instead of telling you to use the usual portal
- Generic sign-off, no name or ticket number

YOUR TURN

Spot the fake: what's wrong here?

From: Dana Okafor <dana.okafor@brightline-supply.example>

Updated bank details for invoice #4471

Hi, quick note before you process this month's invoice. We've moved banks, so please use the new account below from now on. Our auditors need the change made today.

New account: [details]

Thanks so much, Dana

RED FLAGS

- Look closely at the sender: brightline (capital I, not l)
- A bank change by email only
- “Today” deadline
- No phone call, no paperwork, no change request form

The “boss” who needs gift cards

- “Are you at your desk? I need a quick favour.” from a manager's name
- Then: buy gift cards for a client or staff reward, send the codes, keep it quiet
- Often sent when the real person is travelling or in meetings
- Real managers don't buy gifts with codes over email or text

Invoice and vendor payment fraud

- Fake invoices for services we never ordered
- Real invoices from a hacked supplier, with new bank details
- Pressure: late fees, “final notice”, “auditors need it today”
- Rule: bank detail changes are always confirmed by phone, on a number we already have
- Two people approve new payees and changes

Payroll diversion and W-2 requests

- “Please update my direct deposit to this new account” from an employee's name
- “Send me all employee W-2s for a review” from an executive's name
- Both are confirmed in person or by phone, never by email alone
- Staff: change your own pay details only through our payroll system

Phone, voice and video

Fake IT · codes · voice clones · QR codes

The fake IT call and the code request

- “Hi, it's IT. We're seeing an issue with your account, I just need to verify you.”
- Then: read me the code we just sent, or approve this sign-in prompt
- A flood of sign-in prompts you didn't start? Deny them all and report it
- Nobody legitimate needs your one-time code, ever, including our IT team

Voice clones and deepfake calls

- A few seconds of audio can be enough to clone a voice
- Fake video calls with an “executive” have been used to authorise large transfers
- If a call asks for money or sensitive data, verify on a known number or in person
- Agree a verification step for urgent payment requests, not just “it sounded like her”

Smishing and QR codes

- Texts about deliveries, tolls, password resets or “your boss needs you”
- QR codes in emails or stuck on posters can lead to fake login pages
- Treat a QR code like a link: check where it goes before signing in
- Log in to work systems only from the usual app or bookmark

Protect yourself and the company

Verify · lock down · report

THE VERIFY RULE

Stop. Verify on a known channel. Then act.

1 Stop when you see two of the three tells

2 Verify using contact details you already have: the phone list, the supplier file, in person

3 Never use the phone number, link or reply address in the message you're checking

4 Payments: new payees and bank changes need a second person's approval

LOCK IT DOWN

4 habits that block most account takeovers

- A unique password for work accounts, in a password manager
- Multi-factor sign-in on, ideally passkeys or an authenticator app
- Updates installed when prompted, on laptops and phones
- Lock your screen when you step away

REPORTING

How to report something here

[how to report at our company: e.g. forward to security@yourcompany.com or call IT on ext. 200]

- Report even if you're not sure. Especially if you're not sure.
- Report even if you clicked. Fast reports limit the damage.
- No blame. The person who reports early is helping everyone.

IT HAPPENED

I clicked, or I paid. Now what?

- Clicked a link or entered a password: report it now, then change that password
- Shared a code or approved a prompt: report it now so IT can lock the account
- Sent a payment: call the bank immediately; the first hours matter most for recalling it
- Write down what happened, when, and who you spoke to

SCENARIO 1 OF 3

The urgent invoice

It's 4:45 pm on Friday. An email from a supplier you use every month says their bank account has changed and this month's invoice must be paid to the new account today, or they'll stop deliveries. The email address looks right. What do you do?

What do you do? Talk it through in pairs for 60 seconds.

SCENARIO 2 OF 3

The call from IT

Your phone rings. “Hi, this is Sam from IT. We've spotted suspicious sign-ins on your account and we're locking it down. I've just sent you a code, can you read it back so I can confirm it's you?”

What do you do? Talk it through in pairs for 60 seconds.

SCENARIO 3 OF 3

The manager on the road

A text from your manager's name: “In back-to-back meetings, can't talk. Need 5 x $200 gift cards for a client thank-you before 3pm. Send me photos of the codes and I'll sort the expense later. Keep it a surprise.”

What do you do? Talk it through in pairs for 60 seconds.

CHECK WHAT STUCK

Quiz: 12 questions, 5 minutes

- Open book, no trick questions
- Pass mark: 10 out of 12
- Answers and explanations straight after
- Everyone who completes it gets a certificate

TAKE THESE WITH YOU

The 5 rules

1. Two tells (rush, secrecy, unusual request)? Stop.
2. Verify on a channel you already have.
3. Never share a code or approve a prompt you didn't start.
4. Bank changes and new payees: phone check + second approval.
5. Report fast. No blame.

Thank you

Questions? · Certificates · Scam Decoded